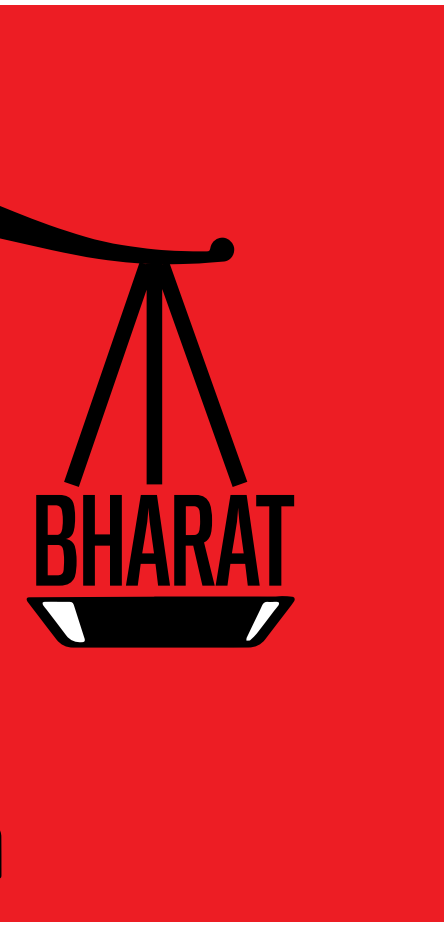




By **ARVIND P.DATAR**

A QUESTION OF **PROPRIETY**

THE USE OF BHARAT AT THE G20 SUMMIT OUGHT NOT TO HAVE BEEN DONE WHEN OUR CONSTITUTIONAL ENGLISH NAME CONTINUES TO BE INDIA

of Germany is Deutschland. It will be strange and improper if an invitation in English is issued by the Emperor of Nippon or the Chancellor of Deutschland. Indeed, India is the name that has to be used when the communication is in English and in international meetings.

It is necessary to trace the historical and constitutional origins of the word India. In the *History of Dharmashastra* by Dr P.V. Kane (who was awarded the Bharat Ratna for this monumental work), it is stated that the word Hindu or Hidu was first applied by the Persian emperors Darius (522-486 BC) and Xerxes (486-465 BC) to the territory and the people who lived to the west and to the east of the river Sindhu. Kane points out that the word Sindhu occurs more than 200 times in the Rig Veda. He points out that the Puranas refer to Bharatvarsha, which has the same extent as modern India and the name is attributed to Bharata, the son of Dushyant and Shakuntala. However, the Greeks referred to the people in the same region as Indoi, from which came the word Indian (see volume V, Part II, pp. 1,613-1,614). Thus, the name 'India' has a Greek origin and has nothing to do with any colonial legacy. Indeed, until the British consolidated their power, India never had a common ruler who identified the peninsula with either Bharat or India.

IN THE PAST, SEVERAL CITIES HAVE BEEN RENAMED. BUT THESE WERE ONLY SYMBOLIC AND NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR REAL AND SUBSTANTIAL CHANGE

Constitutionally, the preamble to the Government of India Act, 1800, noted that the "territorial possession of the United Company of Merchants of England trading to the East Indies, in the peninsula of India, have become so much extended" that there was a need to make regulations for due government and better administration of justice. A series of similar acts finally ended with the Government of India Act, 1935, and Section 5 proclaimed that there shall be a united Federation of India, consisting of the governors' provinces, the chief commissioners' provinces and the Indian (princely) states which had acceded to the federation. The Federation of India later became the Union of India excluding, of course, the territories that became Pakistan.

It is possible to amend the Constitution of India and change 'India, that is Bharat' to 'Bharat, that is India'. Alternatively, we can eliminate India al-